

That non-confrontational style of interviewing earned Allahbadia's videos traction last year but also invited "backlash" from select quarters criticising him for peddling the government's agenda. The 30-year-old creator addressed it by having opposition voices such as economist Raghuram Rajan discussing the failures of the BJP. Allahbadia doesn't let detractors get to him, especially when he has a business to sustain, one that employs 70 people and includes a talent management firm. While interviewing politicians, he knows that "irrespective of how well prepared you go [for the interview], someone is going to be disappointed.... In our industry, it is all about attention; negative publicity is good publicity applies to us." Ask if he identifies with any political labels, and his reply is: "I see myself as a centrist. That's how the audience sees it also. I'm everybody's friend in the ecosystem. I hang out with both Dhruv Rathee and Abhi and Niyu."

WHOSE WAR IS IT ANYWAY

That doesn't stop people from bracketing these creators under labels or accusing them of paid partnerships or 'collabs' [collaborations], especially as their popularity only grows by the day. Thus Rathee is viewed as a champion of the Left liberals, while the Right roots for the likes of Abhi and Niyu, AKTK and The Jaipur Dialogues. The battle between the government and Opposition spokespersons, already noisy and heated in TV news debates, has spread even to the YouTube videos. The Jaipur Dialogues hosted journalist Palki Sharma, who called Rathee a "German cockroach". "A lot of political conversation starts off as mudslinging and never stops. There's no end to how low you can go, which is why we don't engage in it," says Niyati, the second half of Abhi and Niyu. Yet, they too called Rathee a "bully" in their video and took a dig at his dictatorship video.

Policy, not politics is what interests them, says the Mumbai-based couple. They have had only one BJP